

# Teacher Manual — M/J Music Theory 1

Florida course #1300000 · Grades 6–8 · Full year · 37 weekly modules · ~80 student-minutes per week · On-Demand (async), also usable by live classes

**Facilitator copy.** This manual contains answer keys, rubrics, grading guidance, and internal standards codes. **Do not publish it to students** or attach it anywhere in the student-facing course.

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## 1. HOW THIS COURSE WORKS

**The shape of the year.** 37 weekly modules across four quarters, about 80 student-minutes per module. Quarter 1 (M1–9) builds the fundamentals: notation, rhythm, meter, major scales, key signatures, intervals, triads, and primary chords. Quarter 2 (M10–18) covers minor scales and keys, compound meter and syncopation, advanced intervals, and a full triad-and-Roman-numeral sequence. Quarter 3 (M19–27) turns to ear training (solfege, dictation), seventh chords and secondary dominants, and music history from Bach through Schubert plus world traditions. Quarter 4 (M28–37) is applied music: pentatonic scales, blues, jazz, pop song analysis, songwriting, global rhythm, score reading, a composition capstone, music technology, and a year-end portfolio.

The course is fully asynchronous by design. There are no live sessions, no named-teacher dependencies, and every activity a live class would do together has an async equivalent already built in (posted recordings instead of live presentations, discussion boards instead of class listening sessions). A live class can use the same content unchanged — see Section 2 for the 4-day-week adaptation.

### A typical lesson page

Lessons are single GitHub-hosted HTML pages embedded in Canvas and marked "done" by the student (they carry no grade). Walking down a representative page (Lesson 10.01, "Dark and Beautiful: Natural Minor Scales"):

- **Navy/cyan Optima chrome** (header, owl, metadata strip) frames every page identically; in-lesson accents are green (teaching) and purple (activity).
- **Objectives and time pills** up top: numbered green circles say what the student will be able to do, with an estimated time.
- **A prominent lead visual** built in CSS/SVG, never a photo of a textbook: here, a side-by-side C major vs. C natural minor grid with the lowered notes highlighted, then a staff diagram of A minor. Every module leads with a diagram of this kind (Circle of Fifths, interval ruler, triad stack,

12-bar blues grid, mock DAW, etc.).

- **Short teaching blocks** between visuals; prose is kept brief for grades 6–8.
- **Two or three embedded widgets** (purple frames, each with its own Reset): a "Quick Check-in" with no wrong answer, an auto-feedback multiple-choice check whose wrong answers teach, flip cards the student answers in a notebook before flipping, and "notebook first" commit-then-reveal challenges.
- **Free-tool links out:** Open Music Theory (the sole text, free and openly licensed), musictheory.net, teoria.com, MuseScore, IMSLP scores, and YouTube search links for in-copyright recordings (never embedded).
- **A closing "what you'll do next" card** pointing to the week's Canvas items.

Nothing on the lesson page needs grading. Every graded touchpoint is a Canvas-native item listed below.

### A typical week (one module)

| Order | Item                | What the student does                                                                                                                            | Graded?             | Tier |
|-------|---------------------|--------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|---------------------|------|
| 1     | Intro wrapper       | Canvas Quiz in <b>survey mode</b> : first answer to the module's essential question, an objectives acknowledgment, a confidence rating           | Completion/ungraded | 4    |
| 2     | Lesson page         | Reads the GitHub lesson, works the widgets, marks done                                                                                           | Completion          | 1    |
| 3     | Practice assignment | Hands-on work in a free tool (MuseScore, musictheory.net, teoria, IMSLP score, Word) with screenshot/PDF/file proof; resubmission always allowed | Completion          | 1    |
| 4     | Module Check quiz   | ~10 auto-graded questions, multiple attempts; full answer key lives in the module spec                                                           | Auto                | 1    |
| 5     | Discussion          | A specific, music-grounded prompt + reply to 1 classmate (Module 1: reply to 2). Modules 3 and 4 have no discussion.                             | Simple rubric       | 2    |
| 6     | Outro wrapper       | Survey quiz: essential question revisited, confidence rating, "what's still unclear," and a virtue reflection                                    | Completion/ungraded | 4    |

Five weeks add a quarter-level Tier 3 assessment on top of this skeleton (next table).

### Major assessments

| Assessment                                   | Module | Tier | Points | What it asks                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                              | Teacher time            |
|----------------------------------------------|--------|------|--------|-------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|-------------------------|
| <b>Q1 Fundamentals Assessment</b>            | M9     | 3    | 100    | Cumulative Q1: notation, meter, scales, key signatures, intervals, triads, primary chords; includes 3 short-answer explanation questions. One attempt.                                                                                                                                                                                    | ~5 min/student (rubric) |
| <b>Q2 Assessment</b>                         | M18    | 3    | 100    | Section A notation (40), Section B analysis of a teacher-provided 4-measure passage (35), Section C three short answers (25). Teacher must prepare the Section B passage — spec suggests I–IV–V–I with a I6 and a passing vi.                                                                                                             | ~5 min/student (rubric) |
| <b>World Music Research Project</b>          | M27    | 3    | 12     | Research + listening journal + comparison to a course concept + honest reflection, on a tradition not covered in the lesson.                                                                                                                                                                                                              | ~5 min/student (rubric) |
| <b>Q4 Composition &amp; Analysis Project</b> | M35    | 3    | 40     | Five parts: original 16-measure MuseScore composition (score + audio), self-analysis, 200–300-word program note, a Roman-numeral analysis of Beethoven's Minuet in G (IMSLP), and a Revision Log documenting how peer/teacher critique improved the draft. Students post a draft to the Preview Discussion first, then revise and submit. | ~5 min/student (rubric) |
| <b>Year-End Portfolio</b>                    | M37    | 3    | 12     | Curation checkpoint: best composition, best analysis, best ear-training result, and a 1–2-page reflection. Grade the curation and reflection; do <b>not</b> re-grade the works.                                                                                                                                                           | ~2–3 min/student        |

**Point-scale note** **VERIFY** — the five Tier 3 items carry unequal raw points (100 / 100 / 12 / 40 / 12) as built. This is harmless **only if** the gradebook uses weighted assignment groups (Section 6). If your gradebook is points-based instead, rescale the M27/M35/M37 items (e.g., enter them out of 100) before students submit.

**Sequencing note for the facilitator.** The course teaches triads and Roman numerals twice: once quickly in Q1 (M8–9, as part of the fundamentals sweep to the Q1 assessment) and again slowly and from scratch in Q2 (M16 build, M17 qualities, M18 inversions + Roman numerals). Treat Q2 as the deliberate deep pass: students who found M8–9 fast get a second, slower runway, and the Q2 assessment is where mastery is expected. If a strong student asks why M16 feels familiar, say exactly that.

## 2. ADAPTING THE ASYNC MODULES TO A LIVE CLASS MEETING 4 DAYS PER WEEK

The course was written async-first, so a live class uses the same Canvas modules unchanged — the live meetings *wrap* the async work rather than replace it. Students still submit everything in Canvas (so the gradebook and analytics work exactly as in Section 6). The one standing rule: never turn the multiple-attempt practice items into one-shot live tests; the async design's generosity is the pedagogy.

### The standard 4-day weekly rhythm

Each module maps cleanly onto four meetings because it has four natural centers of gravity: the concept, the practice, the conversation, and the check.

| Day                              | Focus          | What to do live                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                             | What stays in Canvas                                                                                    |
|----------------------------------|----------------|---------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|---------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| <b>Day 1 — Launch</b>            | The concept    | Open with the module's essential question as bell work (the same question the intro wrapper asks) and let 3–4 students answer aloud. Then teach the lesson's lead visual live — draw the staff / circle / triad stack on the board while students follow on the lesson page. Work the lesson's widgets together on a projector: have the class commit to an answer out loud before you tap. | Students complete the intro wrapper and mark the lesson done that evening (10 min).                     |
| <b>Day 2 — Practice</b>          | The skill      | Run the module's practice assignment as a workshop: MuseScore / musictheory.net / staff paper out, you circulate. Add the live-only layer the async course can only simulate: clap the rhythms, sing the scales on solfege, play the triads on a keyboard, echo-clap and call-and-response. This is where the improvise / play-by-ear benchmarks come alive.                                | Students upload the same screenshot/file proof to the Canvas assignment before leaving (or that night). |
| <b>Day 3 — Converse</b>          | The discussion | Run the module's discussion prompt as a live listening circle: play the music (or student picks), talk it through, push for the specific musical detail the rubric wants. Close by having each student post a 2–3-sentence version of what they said to the Canvas discussion (5 min, devices out) so the graded record matches the async course.                                           | Replies to 1 classmate happen in Canvas by end of day.                                                  |
| <b>Day 4 — Check &amp; close</b> | The evidence   | Module Check quiz in class (multiple attempts stay on). Reteach on the spot from wrong-answer patterns. Close with the outro wrapper as a written exit ticket — the essential question revisited plus the virtue reflection, said aloud by two volunteers.                                                                                                                                  | Nothing; the week is done.                                                                              |

### Assessment weeks (M9, M18, M27, M35, M37)

Compress the rhythm: Day 1 launch + review game at the board, Day 2 supervised work session on the Tier 3 assessment, Day 3 finish + peer preview (M35's draft-share discussion becomes a real mini-recital; M37's portfolio walkthrough becomes live 3-minute presentations, which is what those items were originally designed from), Day 4 quiz + outro + individual conferences while others finish.

### One live suggestion per module week

| Wk | Module                  | The one live move that adds the most                                                                                                                                             |
|----|-------------------------|----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| 1  | What Is Music Theory?   | Play 3 contrasting clips; class tags each with one of the six elements before the lesson names them. Do the scavenger hunt as a team race.                                       |
| 2  | Staff, Clefs & Keyboard | Whiteboard note-naming relay: teams race to label EGBDF/FACE; end at a real or on-screen keyboard finding middle C.                                                              |
| 3  | Note Values & Rests     | Body-percussion the note-value tree (whole = 4 claps held, etc.); students clap each other's 4-beat patterns back. (No discussion this week — use the time for clapping rounds.) |
| 4  | Simple & Compound Meter | March vs. waltz vs. jig: play one of each, class conducts along and votes the meter before the lesson explains why. (No discussion this week.)                                   |
| 5  | The Major Scale         | Sing the scale on solfege up to Ti and stop — let the room feel the pull, then resolve. Build G major together at the board.                                                     |
| 6  | Circle of Fifths        | Draw-the-circle-from-memory race (the practice assignment, live); winner explains the order of sharps.                                                                           |
| 7  | Intervals               | Interval ear-training as a class game with hand signals (2nd = fingers close, octave = arms wide); use famous-song anchors students volunteer.                                   |
| 8  | Triads                  | Play major/minor/dim/aug on one root; class describes each "color" in one word before learning the labels.                                                                       |

|    |                                       |                                                                                                                                                                                    |
|----|---------------------------------------|------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| 9  | <b>Primary Chords + Q1 Assessment</b> | Assessment week rhythm. Live cadence game: you play endings, class calls "finished / question / surprise."                                                                         |
| 10 | Natural Minor                         | Major-vs-minor blind listening bracket; students defend their call with one musical detail.                                                                                        |
| 11 | Harmonic & Melodic Minor              | Sing/play natural then harmonic minor; let the class hear the raised 7th arrive. Bach Toccata listening together.                                                                  |
| 12 | Minor Keys & Relative Keys            | "Same signature, two keys" detective game with short score excerpts on screen.                                                                                                     |
| 13 | Compound Meter                        | Rock the room in 6/8 (sway on the dotted-quarter beat) vs. march in 4/4; then beam rhythms correctly at the board.                                                                 |
| 14 | Syncopation & Triplets                | Clap "Take Five" and a backbeat; half the room keeps the beat while half claps the syncopation, then swap.                                                                         |
| 15 | Advanced Intervals                    | Tritone hunt: play film/game clips, class raises hands at the tension interval; then invert intervals at the board (sizes add to 9).                                               |
| 16 | Introduction to Triads                | Snowperson-building relay on staff whiteboards (root/third/fifth). Name the review link to M8 out loud — "you've met these; now we own them."                                      |
| 17 | Four Triad Qualities                  | Quality ear-training tournament (teoria on the projector); students hold up M / m / ° / + cards.                                                                                   |
| 18 | <b>Inversions + Q2 Assessment</b>     | Assessment week rhythm. Live figured-bass drill first: same triad, three bass notes, class names the inversion.                                                                    |
| 19 | Solfege & Sight-Singing               | The gift week for live classes: Curwen hand signs together, echo-singing, then students sight-sing 4 notes to a partner instead of recording alone.                                |
| 20 | Rhythmic Dictation                    | You clap, they notate — real dictation rounds with instant board checks; 3-against-2 with two halves of the room.                                                                  |
| 21 | Seventh Chords                        | Stack the four-note snowperson live; play ma7 vs. 7 vs. mi7 and collect one-word "flavor" labels before naming them.                                                               |
| 22 | Secondary Dominants                   | Play I-V/V-V-I vs. I-V-I; class points the moment the "borrowed pull" appears.                                                                                                     |
| 23 | Baroque & Bach                        | Listening circle on the three Bach options; live "count the voices" challenge on the chorale.                                                                                      |
| 24 | Classical: Haydn & Mozart             | Map sonata form live in Mozart 40 with students raising hands at the Recapitulation's "coming home."                                                                               |
| 25 | Romantic Era                          | Feature bingo (chromaticism, extreme dynamics, program music) across 4 short Romantic clips.                                                                                       |
| 26 | Schubert & the Art Song               | Play Erlkönig with the lights down and the translation on screen; class identifies what the piano is painting. (Preview the ballad's dark ending for families first — Section 14.) |
| 27 | <b>World Music Project</b>            | Assessment week rhythm. Students book 3-minute "field reports" on their chosen tradition instead of only posting.                                                                  |
| 28 | Pentatonic Scales                     | Black-keys-only improv circle: every student plays 8 notes over a drone; it always sounds good, and that is the lesson.                                                            |
| 29 | Blues                                 | Class 12-bar jam: you (or a backing track) hold the form, students take 1-bar solos on the blues scale.                                                                            |
| 30 | Jazz Harmony                          | ii-V-I spelling bee at the board, then swing vs. straight eighths clapped as a room.                                                                                               |
| 31 | Popular Song Analysis                 | Form-map a class-voted (clean) hit live on the projector, timestamping sections together.                                                                                          |
| 32 | Songwriting                           | Melody workshop: students trade 4-bar "questions" and write each other's "answers."                                                                                                |
| 33 | Global Rhythm                         | Whole-room tresillo: feet keep the pulse, hands clap 3+3+2; layer the clave on top in two groups.                                                                                  |
| 34 | Score Reading                         | Project the Haydn 94 full score while the recording plays; students track their assigned instrument family and stand at its entrances.                                             |
| 35 | <b>Composition Project</b>            | Assessment week rhythm. Days 2–3 are a real composition workshop; the draft-preview discussion becomes a live play-through with named-moment feedback.                             |
| 36 | Music Technology                      | Live DAW demo (BandLab/Chrome Music Lab on the projector); build a 4-bar loop as a class, discussing each choice. Read the AI callout aloud and let students react.                |
| 37 | <b>Year-End Portfolio</b>             | Portfolio walkthroughs become live 3-minute presentations with applause — this is the recital the async course could only record.                                                  |

### 3. UNGRADED INTERACTIVES & THE INTRO/OUTRO WRAPPERS

#### The in-lesson widgets cost you nothing

The check-ins, auto-feedback choice widgets, flip cards, and "notebook first" reveals on the lesson pages give the student immediate feedback and produce **no submission and no grading**. They are formation-by-practice, not busywork to chase. A student who skips them shows up indirectly — in quiz scores and thin discussion posts — not as a missing grade. Do not try to police them; read the signals instead.

#### The wrappers are survey quizzes on purpose — and they are your best 20 minutes

Module intro/outro wrappers are **Canvas Quizzes in survey mode**, not content pages, because quiz responses are sortable cohort data. Every intro captures a first answer to the module's essential question and a confidence rating; every outro captures the refined answer, a new confidence rating, "what's still unclear," and a short virtue reflection.

**The highest-leverage move in this course:** spend 15–20 minutes per module triaging outro responses. Sort the confidence item and read the "still unclear" column. Look for: **clusters** (many students naming the same concept → a targeted announcement or a 3-minute reteach note), **droppers** (a student whose confidence fell from intro to outro → an individual check-in message), and **silence** (wrappers not submitted → the earliest disengagement signal you will get, usually a week before a missing assignment).

The essential-question pair (intro first answer → outro revision) is also your best evidence of real learning when a family asks how their student is doing — quote the student's own before/after.

### 4. AI & VR IN THIS COURSE (STUDENT-FACING)

#### AI: awareness, not required use

The course's posture, set in its built callouts: AI awareness is taught factually; **no AI tool is ever required or prohibited**. There are exactly two AI-awareness callouts in the built course:

- **Module 1, "AI and Ear Training":** an AI app can label chords and tempo in seconds, but it cannot train your ear — the skill lives in you, not the tool.
- **Module 36, "AI and Music Tools":** some music tools generate drum patterns, suggest voicings, or complete melodies; AI pattern-matches from existing music rather than hearing; the legal status of AI-generated music is unresolved; be accurate about what tools you used when presenting work as your own.

If a student uses an AI tool on creative work, the course's standard is disclosure and accuracy, not prohibition. Do not add new AI requirements; speak to the two callouts when the topic comes up.

#### VR: one activity, student-chosen space

The course's single VR activity is in Module 1: **Design Your VR Practice Studio** — the student sets up a personal VR music-study space (reference wall, workbench, whiteboard, display shelf), personalizes it, and submits a capture with a one-to-two-sentence rationale. Completion-scored. It is platform-agnostic and location-agnostic by design; describe it by what the student does, not by any platform name. Modules 2–37 contain no VR activities, so there is nothing VR-related to assemble or grade after week 1.

### 5. USING IGNITE AI TO SUPPORT STUDENTS (TEACHER-FACING)

**VERIFY** Ignite AI feature names and availability vary by Canvas release and by what Optima has enabled. Confirm the current feature set in Optima's Canvas instance before leaning on any specific capability; the suggestions below are functional, not button-by-button.

With ~500 students and one facilitator, the Canvas AI assistant is how personal attention scales. The standing rule for everything below: **AI drafts, the teacher decides**. You read, edit, and own anything that reaches a student or family. AI is never used to surveil, rank, or auto-penalize (see

Section 9).

- **Draft individualized Tier 3 feedback.** Paste the rubric and the student's program note / short answers; ask for two specific strengths and one next step in your voice; edit and send. Cuts the 5-minute grading target, keeps the human judgment.
- **Summarize discussion threads.** Before batch-grading a 60-post discussion, ask for a summary of themes and the 5 most substantive posts — then drop your 2–3 public model comments where they teach the most.
- **Mine the wrapper analytics.** Feed the outro "what's still unclear" export and ask for the top 3 confusion clusters; that becomes Monday's announcement paragraph.
- **Surface students needing a nudge** (low outro confidence, missed wrappers, falling quiz scores) and draft the warm check-in message — a coach's note, not a warning letter.
- **Generate practice variants.** A student who failed the interval quiz twice gets a fresh set of five practice items with worked answers, at the same difficulty, in seconds.
- **Family communication.** Draft clear, kind progress summaries (lead with the student's own intro→outro growth), and translate messages for non-English-speaking families where helpful.

## 6. GRADING CATEGORIES & CANVAS GRADEBOOK SETUP

**Proposed scheme** **VERIFY** — the build specs state the 60/25/15 tier emphasis but do not fix Canvas point values for Tier 1/2/4 items (only the five Tier 3 items carry points). The weights below implement the specs' stated emphasis; confirm or adjust before publishing, then keep them all year.

### Assignment groups and weights

| Canvas assignment group      | Tier | Weight | What goes in it                                                                                                                                                      | Scoring                                |
|------------------------------|------|--------|----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|----------------------------------------|
| Practice & Comprehension     | 1    | 60%    | All practice assignments (completion), all Module Check quizzes (auto, multiple attempts), lesson mark-as-done pages, M1 scavenger hunt / Plan Your Time / VR studio | Completion or auto                     |
| Discussions & Reflections    | 2    | 25%    | Every module discussion (~35 total; none in M3, M4)                                                                                                                  | Simple rubric: full / partial / 0      |
| Quarter Projects & Portfolio | 3    | 15%    | Q1 Assessment (M9), Q2 Assessment (M18), World Music Research Project (M27), Composition & Analysis Project (M35), Year-End Portfolio (M37)                          | 4-criterion Canvas rubrics (Section 7) |
| Module Wrappers              | 4    | 0%     | All intro/outro survey quizzes                                                                                                                                       | Ungraded surveys — analytics only      |

### Setup steps (once, before students arrive)

1. Assignments → create the four groups above; enable **weighted grading** in group settings and enter the weights. (Weighted groups are what make the unequal Tier 3 raw points — 100/100/12/40/12 — harmless.)
2. Build wrappers as **Quizzes** → **survey/ungraded**; assign them to the Wrappers group so they never touch the grade.
3. Set every Module Check to **multiple attempts, keep highest**; set every practice assignment to allow resubmission.
4. Attach the Section 7 rubrics to the five Tier 3 assignments as **native Canvas Rubrics** ("use for grading") so they score in SpeedGrader.
5. Set a gentle missing/late policy consistent with On-Demand pacing (attendance = sincere assignment completion); avoid auto-zeros that fire while a student is still pacing legitimately.
6. Add every item as a **module requirement** so the module-progress view works as your at-a-glance completion signal across all the completion-scored scaffolding.

### Gradebook map

Per ordinary module (34 of 37): practice assignment → Practice 60% group (completion); Module Check → Practice group (auto); discussion → Discussions 25% group (full/partial/0); intro + outro → Wrappers (ungraded). Assessment modules add their Tier 3 item to the Projects 15% group: M9 (100 pts), M18 (100), M27 (12), M35 (40), M37 (12).

## 7. RUBRICS & ANSWER GUIDES FOR EVERY TEACHER-GRADED ITEM

The course uses one stable 4-criterion rubric family for every Tier 3 item — the criteria never drift, only the point scale. Grade at ~5 minutes per student: read for specificity and honesty, not length. **Honest statements of uncertainty are credited, never penalized** — this is written into the specs.

### Q1 Fundamentals Assessment (M9) — 100 pts, 4 × 25

| Criterion (25 each)              | Full (25)                                                                                                           | Partial (18 / 10)                               | None (0)              |
|----------------------------------|---------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|-------------------------------------------------|-----------------------|
| <b>Understanding of material</b> | All Q1 concepts (staff, clefs, rhythm, scales, key signatures, intervals, triads, primary chords) handled correctly | Most correct with minor gaps / significant gaps | No genuine engagement |
| <b>Quality of reasoning</b>      | Correct vocabulary; genuine thinking, not memorized phrases                                                         | Mostly sound / partially sound                  | Absent                |
| <b>Clarity &amp; precision</b>   | Clean, correct notation; accidentals placed correctly; accurate spelling of intervals/triads                        | Minor notation slips / repeated slips           | Illegible or absent   |
| <b>Intellectual honesty</b>      | Genuine engagement; acknowledges uncertainty; no copied answers                                                     | Mostly genuine                                  | Copied or evasive     |

**Short-answer section (3 questions):** no fixed key by design — full credit is a thorough explanation in correct Q1 vocabulary showing genuine thinking; an answer that reasons from what the student knows and names its own uncertainty earns full credit on honesty.

### Q2 Assessment (M18) — 100 pts, 4 × 25

Criteria 1–2 as above (scoped to Q2: minor scales/keys, compound meter, syncopation, advanced intervals, triad qualities, inversions, Roman numerals). Criteria 3–4 are **Clarity and Precision** and **Accuracy of Notation** (renamed from Q1's honesty criterion to meet Q2's notation demands; the spec offers "Intellectual Honesty and Accuracy" as an optional retitle).

- **Section A Notation (40):** three forms of A minor; four quality triads on F; G major triad in three inversions with figured bass; seven diatonic triads in D major with correct-case Roman numerals.
- **Section B Analysis (35):** label Roman numerals + inversions in the teacher-provided 4-measure C major passage; circle and name the authentic cadence (V–I); identify the non-primary triad. **You must prepare this passage** — spec suggestion: I–IV–V–I with a I6 in m. 2 and a passing vi.
- **Section C Short answers (25):** (1) why harmonic minor is useful though rarely a melody — full credit names the raised 7th creating a leading tone / stronger V; (2) simple vs. compound meter in own words with one example each — full credit gets the division of the beat (2 vs. 3) right; (3) minor vs. diminished triad — full credit identifies the **diminished** triad's tritone (root to d5) and explains its instability.

### World Music Research Project (M27) — 12 pts, 4 × 3

Same four criteria at Full = 3 / Partial = 2 / None = 0. Full credit: all four research aspects (instruments, pitch organization, rhythm organization, social context) accurate; the comparison connects one feature to a specific Music Theory I concept accurately on both sides; musical terms used correctly; the reflection names a specific, genuine limit of understanding and what would resolve it.

### Q4 Composition & Analysis Project (M35) — 40 pts, 4 × 10

Full = 10 / partial = 5–7 / minimal = 1–4 / none = 0 per criterion. Full credit: the composition accurately uses at least two theory concepts and the Beethoven Minuet in G analysis correctly identifies key, chords, and texture with measure citations (Understanding); chord labels match the notation and the program note explains *why* choices were made (Reasoning); clean readable score, precise prose (Clarity); names a specific difficulty and what was tried (Honesty). "A concise response that names exact measures, exact chords, and a genuine difficulty is full credit."

### Year-End Portfolio (M37) — 12 pts, 4 × 3

Checkpoint-calibrated: grade **curation quality and honest reflection only** — the portfolio's components were already graded in their home modules; do not re-grade the composition. An un-curated dump scores partial on Reasoning; an honest "here is what I still don't understand" earns full credit on Honesty.

## The standing discussion rubric (every Tier 2 item)

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**Full** = substantive post meeting the prompt's specific asks (a named piece, a specific musical detail, the required vocabulary) plus the required reply. **Partial** = vague post ("it sounded nice") or missing reply. **Zero** = missing. Per-instance full-credit shapes are in the Section 8 table. Batch-grade weekly; drop 2–3 public model comments early in each week — the specs supply model posts for many modules (e.g., a timestamped Miles Davis "All Blues" swing example for M30, a "0:45 Hallelujah hemiola" example for M20).

## 8. DISCUSSIONS, QUIZZES & ACTIVITIES: HOW TO RUN AND GRADE EACH ONE

### The types in this course

- **Auto-graded Module Check quiz** (every module): ~10 questions, multiple attempts, keep highest. Full answer key is in each module's spec. No teacher grading — use the item-analysis to spot a concept the cohort missed, then reteach in the announcement.
- **Completion practice assignment** (every module): screenshot / MuseScore file / Word doc proof. Grade on genuine attempt, not correctness; resubmission always open. Glance, mark complete, move on.
- **Structured discussion** (all modules except M3, M4): standing rubric in Section 7. Batch-read weekly.
- **Survey wrapper** (intro + outro, every module): ungraded; triage the outro (Section 3).
- **Tier 3 project/assessment** (M9, M18, M27, M35, M37): rubric-graded in SpeedGrader (Section 7).
- **VR capture** (M1 only): completion.

### Per-instance discussion guide (full-credit shape for each)

| Module | Discussion                           | Full-credit post contains                                                                            |
|--------|--------------------------------------|------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| 1      | Share Your Soundtrack                | 2–3 songs + one of the six elements named in one; <b>2</b> replies                                   |
| 2      | Reading the Staff                    | one thing clefs made easier + one still-confusing, with a specific note/line                         |
| 5      | Major Scale                          | describes the leading-tone pull after singing to Ti                                                  |
| 6      | Circle of Fifths                     | two adjacent keys + why related (share six of seven pitches)                                         |
| 7      | Interval Listening                   | a real song + interval named (direction + best-guess size)                                           |
| 8      | Triad Quality                        | one word each for major vs. minor + the note difference that causes it                               |
| 9      | Cadence Listening                    | a finished-sounding ending + an open/question ending, each described                                 |
| 10–12  | Minor / relative-key listening       | named piece, major-vs-minor call with a musical reason, relative key where asked                     |
| 13–15  | Feel / rhythm / dissonance           | named song + specific beat or interval detail + one lesson term                                      |
| 16–18  | Triad / harmonic analysis            | quality vocabulary or Roman-numeral evidence from a real song                                        |
| 19     | Solfège in Action                    | a posted sight-singing recording + brief reflection                                                  |
| 20     | Hemiola Listening                    | a specific moment in Handel's Hallelujah where grouping shifts                                       |
| 21–22  | Dominant 7th / Borrowed Pull         | a song moment + explanation tied to chord function/secondary dominant                                |
| 23–26  | History listening (Baroque→Schubert) | named piece + a specific style feature + correct era/style vocabulary                                |
| 27     | World Music                          | chosen tradition + a specific research surprise                                                      |
| 28–34  | Applied listening                    | a specific song + the target feature (pentatonic, blue note, swing, schema, tresillo, texture) heard |
| 35     | Composition Preview                  | a draft recording + 3 sentences; reply names a <b>specific</b> moment ("sounds good" fails)          |
| 36     | Technology & Music                   | one change tech made + one benefit and one trade-off                                                 |
| 37     | Portfolio Walkthrough                | a 2–4 min recorded walkthrough of one item; reply optional                                           |

## 9. COACH, NOT CATCH

Your job in this course is to move each student forward, not to detect and punish. In practice:

- Feedback names the next step and leads with what is working. The rubric is a teaching tool, not a verdict.
- Tier 1 practice and Module Checks allow multiple attempts and resubmission on purpose — that is the learning, not a loophole.
- Use wrapper analytics and Ignite AI to find students who need help **early** and reach out warmly — not to build a case.

- On suspected AI misuse or copied work: open a conversation, ask the student to talk through their thinking, treat it as formation. The course's AI stance is disclosure and accuracy (Section 4), not accusation-first enforcement.
- Public discussion comments model good musical thinking; they never single out weak work for criticism.

## 10. WEEKLY ANNOUNCEMENT SCRIPTS

Because students pace asynchronously, the weekly announcement is your main presence. Keep it short and human. Reusable template:

### TEMPLATE — ANY MODULE

This week we're in **Module [N]: [title]**. The big idea: [one sentence]. Don't miss: [the one thing — a tricky concept or a due assessment]. If [common sticking point] trips you up, [one concrete tip]. I dropped a couple of model posts in the discussion — take a look before you post. You've got this. — [your name]

### MODULE 1 — WELCOME

Welcome to Music Theory 1! Start on the Welcome page, then run the Course Scavenger Hunt so nothing surprises you later. This year we're learning how music actually works — by the end you'll hear songs differently. Set up your VR practice studio when you get a chance; it's a fun one. Message me anytime through Canvas. — [your name]

### MODULE 9 — BEFORE THE Q1 ASSESSMENT

You've reached the end of Quarter 1 — nice work. This week's **Q1 Fundamentals Assessment** pulls together everything from notation to primary chords. It's one attempt, so review your Module Checks first (they're still open for practice). Read the short-answer questions slowly; I'm looking for your genuine thinking in correct vocabulary, not memorized phrases — and it's fine to say what you're unsure about. — [your name]

### SITUATIONAL — LOW-CONFIDENCE OUTRO

I noticed some of us marked low confidence on [concept] last module. That's exactly what this course expects at this stage — it clicks with practice. Here's a 3-minute reteach: [link/tip]. Redo the practice as many times as you like; it only helps. — [your name]

### SITUATIONAL — RE-ENGAGEMENT NUDGE

Haven't seen you in the last module and I want to make sure you're okay. Pick up at [module] — just the lesson and the check to start. Reply here or message me and tell me one thing that would help. — [your name]

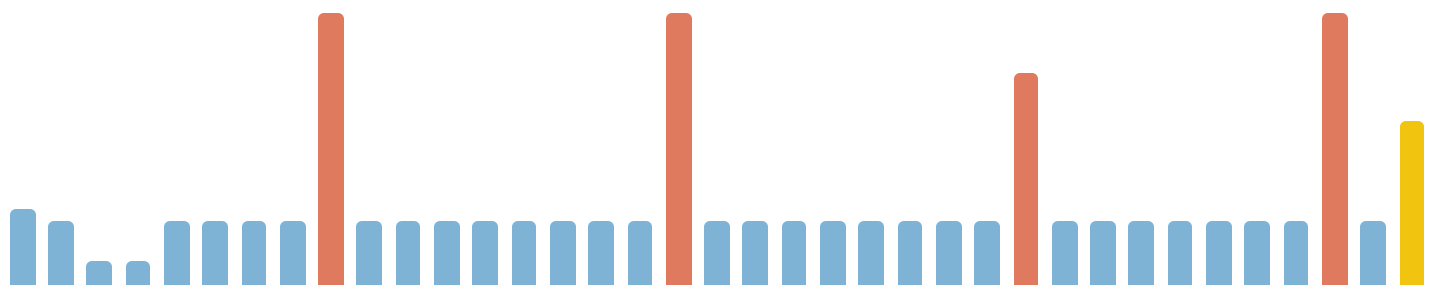
## 11. TEACHER WORKFLOW & WORKLOAD MAP

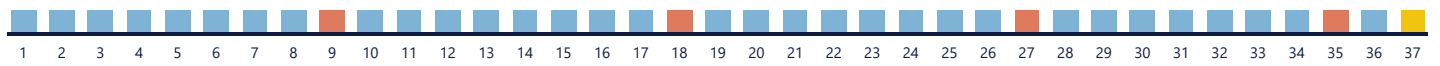
### A normal (non-assessment) week, in order

1. Triage last module's outro analytics (15–20 min) — the highest-value task.
2. Batch-grade the discussion on the full/partial/0 rubric; drop 2–3 model comments (Tier 2, ~2–3 h across the cohort).
3. Glance-complete the practice assignments; scan Module Check item-analysis (Tier 1, ~0 h).
4. Post the weekly announcement (Section 10).
5. Answer Canvas messages (target: one school day).

Tier 1 costs ~0 grading hours (auto/completion). Tier 2 is the steady weekly load. Tier 3 lands only five times and is the real time cost — budget ~5 minutes × enrollment on M9, M18, M27, M35, spread across the submission window, and ~2–3 min × enrollment on M37.

### Relative teacher-grading load by module





■ light (one discussion, all else auto/completion) ■ moderate (checkpoint Tier 3) ■ heavy (major Tier 3 assessment). Plan extra time on Modules 9, 18, 27, and 35.

## 12. STANDARDS COVERAGE MAP (TEACHER-ONLY)

Florida course #1300000, MU.68 benchmarks. Codes live here only — never on any student-facing page or the syllabus. This map is read from the built course's internal alignment files. **See the coverage-check note at the end of this section for the two thinly-covered benchmarks flagged during publish prep.**

| Benchmark    | What it asks                                         | Where it lives (modules)                                                      |
|--------------|------------------------------------------------------|-------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| <b>C.1.1</b> | Listening strategies for unfamiliar works            | M1 (six-elements listening) + woven through nearly every listening discussion |
| <b>C.1.2</b> | Compare aesthetic impact vs. composer intent         | M25 Romantic Listening Journal, Paragraph 3 (dedicated, assessed)             |
| <b>C.2.3</b> | Critique own composition/improv to improve           | M35 Revision Log (critique → revise, assessed in the rubric); M22 seed        |
| <b>C.3.1</b> | Criteria for why a work is an exemplar               | M35 (Beethoven analysis), M37 (best-work selection)                           |
| <b>F.1.1</b> | Create composition/performance manipulating elements | M32 (8-bar melody), M35 (capstone); prepared M9, M13–18                       |
| <b>F.2.1</b> | Routes creator→consumer                              | M30 worksheet Part B (trace-the-route, assessed) + careers callout            |
| <b>F.3.2</b> | IP law + safe/legal/responsible use                  | M31 (primary IP module), M36 (sampling/licensing/AI)                          |
| <b>F.3.3</b> | Compositional-process tasks + workplace              | M30, M34 (careers), M35 (process)                                             |
| <b>H.2.2</b> | How technology changed music                         | M36 (primary), seeded from M2 notation-as-technology                          |
| <b>H.2.3</b> | Classify by genre/style/period                       | M23–27 history, M28–33 applied styles                                         |
| <b>H.3.1</b> | Connections to other content areas                   | M1, M5–6 (math of scales/tuning), M37                                         |
| <b>H.3.2</b> | How absence of music would affect other areas        | M1 Share Your Soundtrack, "music gone" reflection (dedicated, assessed)       |
| <b>O.2.2</b> | Major/minor tonality via performance & composition   | M5–12, M16–18, M21 (broad coverage)                                           |
| <b>O.3.1</b> | Instrumentation + expression convey idea/mood        | M7–9, M34 (score reading)                                                     |
| <b>S.1.1</b> | Improvise rhythmic/melodic phrases                   | M5 (seed), M19, M28–29, M31 (blues/pentatonic improv)                         |
| <b>S.1.3</b> | Arrange (melody/form/rhythm/voicing)                 | M13–15, M34–35                                                                |
| <b>S.1.4</b> | Play melodies by ear                                 | M7, M14, M28, M30–33                                                          |
| <b>S.1.6</b> | Compose a melody over a progression                  | M9 (first step), M32 (full), M35                                              |
| <b>S.1.8</b> | Mixing/editing with software                         | M36 (primary music-technology activity)                                       |
| <b>S.3.3</b> | Sight-read exercises/repertoire                      | M2–18 (note-naming and reading throughout Q1–Q2)                              |
| <b>S.3.4</b> | Compare written notation to aural for accuracy       | M4, M19–20 (dictation), M36–37                                                |
| <b>S.3.5</b> | Notate phrases performed by someone else             | M3–4 (seed), M10–12, M20 (dictation), M31                                     |

**Embedded B.E.S.T. / other:** MA.K12.MTR and ELA.K12.EE reasoning standards are woven through the short-answer and discussion work; DA.68.S.2.1 (focus/discipline) and ELD.K12.ELL.SI.1 (ELL communication) are supported by the course structure. These are not separately assessed, consistent with their "embed as applicable" status.

**Coverage check — complete.** A publish-prep audit against #1300000 found all 22 MU.68 benchmarks present, with four resting on a single light touch. Those four were closed with a dedicated, assessed touchpoint each (revision of 2026-07-13):

- **C.1.2** — M25 Romantic Listening Journal now has a Paragraph 3 comparing the student's hypothesis of the composer's intent to the aesthetic impact on the listener.
- **C.2.3** — the M35 Composition & Analysis Project now runs draft → peer/teacher critique in the Preview Discussion → revise → submit with a Revision Log; the log is graded within the "Quality of reasoning" rubric criterion (40-point total unchanged).
- **F.2.1** — the M30 worksheet gained a Part B in which students trace a real song's route from creator to listener with at least four named stops.
- **H.3.2** — the M1 Share Your Soundtrack discussion added a "music gone" reflection on what would be lost if music vanished from one non-playlist context.

All four are completion- or rubric-assessed and add no net teacher-grading time (each rides an existing item). Standards codes remain teacher-only; none appear on the student-facing pages.

### 13. WHAT MAKES THIS COURSE CLASSICAL & CULTIVATING CULTURE

#### Classical moves this course actually makes:

- **Primary sources, not summaries.** Students analyze real public-domain scores (Bach chorales, Mozart K. 545, Beethoven's Minuet in G, Haydn 94) on IMSLP rather than reading about them.
- **The Great Conversation in music.** The history arc (Baroque → Classical → Romantic → global → blues/jazz/pop) treats theory as a centuries-long argument students are joining, not a fixed rulebook — the M23 essential question literally asks "who decided the rules?"
- **Notice–Name–Apply.** Every module leads with a heard or seen phenomenon (notice), gives it precise vocabulary (name), and asks the student to use it in practice and a discussion (apply). The commit-then-reveal widgets enforce noticing before naming.
- **Wonder before mechanism.** Intro wrappers ask the open question first; the lesson supplies the machinery second.
- **A virtue thread.** Each outro closes on a named virtue (perseverance, diligence, integrity, excellence, curiosity, open-mindedness, intellectual honesty) tied to the week's real work.

**Cultivating culture asynchronously:** your public discussion comments are the classroom's tone — name students' good musical thinking specifically and often. Weekly announcements should model curiosity (a "listen for this" of your own). Keep the virtue thread visible by echoing it in feedback. Treat every piece of feedback as a relationship, not a transaction: with 500 students, the ones who feel seen are the ones who persist.

## 14. SENSITIVE-CONTENT NOTES & FAMILY SCRIPTS

This is a music-theory course; sensitive content is minimal. Three items may warrant a heads-up for particular families; all are taught factually and none involve explicit material.

| Where           | What                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                              |
|-----------------|-----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| <b>M7, M15</b>  | The tritone's medieval nickname "diabolus in musica" (devil in music), noted alongside its use in heavy-metal riffs and horror-film scores. Named as historical/stylistic context; no media embedded.                                                                             |
| <b>M26</b>      | Schubert's <i>Erkönig</i> is a dramatic Goethe ballad in which a father rides through the night with his sick child, who dies at the end. Taught for its word-painting (galloping piano, the child's fear). <i>Gretchen am Spinnrade</i> sets a text from Goethe's <i>Faust</i> . |
| <b>M29, M33</b> | Blues and global-rhythm history include the music of enslaved people and their descendants in the American South, and Afro-Cuban/West African traditions. Taught as factual cultural history with a respectful, musical-elements framing.                                         |

### SUGGESTED ADVANCE SCRIPT (EDIT AND SEND BEFORE THE RELEVANT MODULE)

Hi families — a quick heads-up as we reach Module [N]. This week we study [item, in one neutral sentence]. It's part of the course because [learning purpose — e.g., "it's a famous example of how music can paint a story," or "it's the historical root of the blues and jazz we'll study next"]. We approach it as musicians, focusing on [the musical elements]. If you have any questions, please reach out — I'm glad to talk it through. — [your name]